

Secretary

From: Jordan Larson [jordan@nakamurausa.com]
Sent: Wednesday, May 19, 2010 5:29 PM
To: Secretary
Subject: Comments about proposed elimination of rate filing requirements for NVOCCs

Date: May 19, 2010

To: Karen V. Gregory
Secretary
Federal Maritime Commission
800 North Capitol Street, N.W.
Room 1046
Washington, D.C. 20573-0001

Dear Ms. Gregory,

As an NVOCC learning about the current proposal that would provide an exemption for rate filings for NVOCCs in exchange for negotiated rate arrangements, we are very pleased that the FMC understands the burden that the current filing process has on smaller NVOCCs. We are very certain that this would lead to a reduction of costs which would benefit our shippers and would also allow us to spend more time with each shipment and deliver a higher level of customer service by taking away the burden and costs of filing and maintaining these rates. This process has become extremely complicated and time consuming with the ever changing surcharges such as fuel, etc. This idea of recording rate arrangements is in the true spirit of commerce and places the importance of this understanding between the NVOCC and the shipper compared to the current emphasis between the NVOCC and the rate filing process. Most importantly, I feel that this would also free up a lot of time that could be better directed towards scrutiny of cargoes/customers related to terrorism, etc. since most NVOCCs place the most importance on timely and accurate rate filing above everything else due to the legal implications. This proposal would free up time and money that could be better served towards spotting suspicious shipments that might otherwise get overlooked by an overworked smaller office which seem to represent the bulk of the NVOCC's in the current marketplace.

Thank you for soliciting comments about this proposal and for coming up with this great idea!

Sincerely,

- Jordan Larson

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